

Top AI Newsletters of 2026: A Comprehensive Research Report

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CATEGORY 1: HIGH-VOLUME DAILY BRIEFINGS (General AI News)

1. The Rundown AI

- **Publisher:** Rowan Cheung (bootstrapped)
 - **Website:** therundown.ai
 - **Frequency:** Daily
 - **Audience:** General tech professionals, AI enthusiasts, business users
 - **Content:** Daily AI news, tool launches, product releases, embedded "how to use it" tutorials
 - **Subscribers:** 2,000,000+ (~50% open rate — nearly double the 31% industry average)
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Rowan Cheung has interviewed Sam Altman, Mark Zuckerberg, and Satya Nadella; launched a companion EdTech platform
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2. TLDR AI

- **Publisher:** Dan Ni (TLDR Network)
 - **Website:** tldr.tech/ai
 - **Frequency:** Daily (Mon-Fri), ~5-minute read
 - **Audience:** ML engineers, AI infrastructure teams, technical PMs, data scientists
 - **Content:** AI/ML research papers, product launches, industry news — dense bullet-point summaries
 - **Subscribers:** 1,250,000+ (TLDR Network as a whole: 7M+ across 9 editions)
 - **Cost:** Free (ad-supported)
 - **Notable:** Dan Ni grew this from a side project in 2018 into a profitable 8-figure media company with 22 remote employees
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3. Superhuman AI

- **Publisher:** Zain Kahn
 - **Website:** superhuman.ai
 - **Frequency:** Daily, strict 3-minute read
 - **Audience:** Professionals leveraging AI for career/productivity; readers from Google, Meta, Nvidia, Apple
 - **Content:** Latest AI news, practical tool recommendations, productivity applications, actionable tutorials
 - **Subscribers:** 1,000,000+
 - **Cost:** Freemium (free core; Pro ~\$14.99/month for video courses + archives)
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4. The Neuron

- **Publisher:** Pete Huang & Noah Edelman; acquired by TechnologyAdvice (Jan 2025)
- **Website:** theneuron.ai
- **Frequency:** Daily

- **Audience:** Beginners and general professionals ("Morning Brew"-style)
 - **Content:** AI industry news, top new AI tools and startups, learning resources, free AI courses
 - **Subscribers:** 550,000+
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Grew from zero to 500K+ in under two years; expanded into a podcast and educational platform serving 20,000+ students
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CATEGORY 2: LINKEDIN-NATIVE AI NEWSLETTERS

5. The Atlas (GenAI.Works)

- **Publisher:** GenAI.Works
 - **Website:** newsletter.genai.works
 - **Frequency:** Biweekly
 - **Audience:** Enterprise executives, independent builders, cross-industry professionals
 - **Content:** Curated AI updates across industries — model releases, enterprise deployment, community highlights
 - **Subscribers:** 3,151,421 LinkedIn subscribers — **largest AI newsletter on LinkedIn in 2026**
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** GenAI.Works has 12 million total community users; acquired Hackmakers and launched an education platform
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6. AI Frontier

- **Publisher:** Steve Nouri (AI4Diversity; LinkedIn community of 14M members)
 - **Website:** linkedin.com/newsletters/ai-frontier
 - **Frequency:** Weekly
 - **Audience:** Broad AI enthusiasts; LinkedIn professional community
 - **Content:** Weekly AI innovations, curated tool recommendations, educational breakdowns
 - **Subscribers:** 847,137+
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Steve Nouri leads the largest AI community on LinkedIn with 14 million members; strong emphasis on diversity in AI
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7. Learn AI Together

- **Publisher:** Alex Wang
 - **Website:** linkedin.com/newsletters/learn-ai-together
 - **Frequency:** Regular
 - **Audience:** Learners at all stages; aims to be "90% buzzword-free"
 - **Content:** Curated learning materials, tutorials, AI/ML/Data Science resources; accessible and educational
 - **Subscribers:** 544,000+
 - **Cost:** Free
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CATEGORY 3: TECHNICAL / AI RESEARCH (For ML Engineers & Researchers)

8. Ahead of AI

- **Publisher:** Sebastian Raschka, PhD (Senior LLM Research Engineer, Lightning AI; former UW-Madison professor)

- **Website:** magazine.sebastianraschka.com
 - **Frequency:** ~2x/month; each issue is a 30-90 minute deep read
 - **Audience:** ML researchers, LLM practitioners, AI engineers wanting architecture-level understanding
 - **Content:** LLM architectures, post-training methods, curated paper roundups with diagrams, code references, citations
 - **Subscribers:** 190,000+
 - **Cost:** Freemium (free + paid Substack)
 - **Notable:** The largest deep-technical AI newsletter; explains the how behind model releases, not just the what
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9. Latent Space

- **Publisher:** Shawn "swyx" Wang & Alessio Fanelli (co-founders, 2022)
 - **Website:** latent.space
 - **Frequency:** Daily AINews digest + weekly long-form essays + podcast episodes
 - **Audience:** AI engineers, founders building model-layer products, applied ML practitioners
 - **Content:** LLM dev tools, AI agents, infrastructure, open-source models; mix of essays, interviews, news roundups
 - **Subscribers:** 200,000+ (newsletter + podcast); podcast is top-10 US Tech on Spotify
 - **Cost:** Free + paid Substack (Discord access for paid)
 - **Notable:** 10 million+ readers and listeners in 2025; tight connection to the AI engineering community
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10. Import AI

- **Publisher:** Jack Clark (co-founder of Anthropic; former Policy Director at OpenAI)
 - **Website:** importai.substack.com
 - **Frequency:** Weekly
 - **Audience:** AI researchers, policy professionals, ML engineers following frontier research
 - **Content:** Detailed analysis of cutting-edge AI research papers; technical + policy implications
 - **Subscribers:** 116,000+ (crossed 100K in January 2026)
 - **Cost:** Freemium (free + paid Substack)
 - **Notable:** Rare combination of deep technical knowledge and policy analysis from one of AI's most connected insiders
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11. Interconnects

- **Publisher:** Nathan Lambert (Senior Research Scientist, Allen Institute for AI / Ai2)
 - **Website:** interconnects.ai
 - **Frequency:** 1-3x/week
 - **Audience:** ML researchers, practitioners focused on open-source models and post-training methods
 - **Content:** Latest AI models, training methods, open model ecosystem; essays, model reviews, researcher interviews
 - **Subscribers:** 60,000+
 - **Cost:** Freemium (free + paid Substack; paid includes Discord with 300+ frontier model researchers)
 - **Notable:** Best newsletter specifically focused on post-training methods and the open model ecosystem
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12. AlphaSignal

- **Publisher:** ML practitioners team
- **Website:** alphasignal.ai
- **Frequency:** Weekly

- **Audience:** ML practitioners, AI researchers, engineers wanting research-grade coverage
 - **Content:** Research paper summaries ranked by a proprietary ML system, model releases, code repositories
 - **Subscribers:** 100,000–150,000
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Uses its own ML-based curation system to surface papers; built by practitioners, for practitioners
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13. The Gradient

- **Publisher:** Volunteer-run by grad students, researchers, and engineers; founded 2017 at Stanford AI Lab (SAIL)
 - **Website:** thegradient.pub
 - **Frequency:** Irregular (magazine-style long-form); "The Update" newsletter is more regular
 - **Audience:** AI/ML researchers, academics, technically sophisticated readers
 - **Content:** Long-form perspectives on AI — deep technical and conceptual analysis
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Non-profit and volunteer-run; oldest researcher-driven AI publication in this list; runs Sigmoid.Social (Mastodon instance)
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14. Gradient Updates (Epoch AI)

- **Publisher:** Epoch AI; primarily written by senior researcher Ege Erdil
 - **Website:** epoch.ai/gradient-updates
 - **Frequency:** Weekly (37 issues in 2025)
 - **Audience:** AI researchers, forecasters, policy analysts, those interested in compute trends
 - **Content:** Single carefully chosen topic per issue — in-depth commentary on AI progress, compute scaling, trajectory forecasting; NO news roundups
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Unique single-topic focus per issue; backed by Epoch AI's data infrastructure for AI trends
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CATEGORY 4: AI BUSINESS / INDUSTRY (For Executives, Investors, Founders)

15. Ben's Bites

- **Publisher:** Ben Tossell (tech entrepreneur)
 - **Website:** bensbites.com
 - **Frequency:** Daily
 - **Audience:** Founders, operators, angel investors, pre-seed deal-flow trackers
 - **Content:** AI news and startup launches in "quick bites" format; business use cases; deal flow
 - **Subscribers:** ~163,000 Substack subscribers
 - **Cost:** Freemium (free + paid Substack)
 - **Notable:** Grew from zero to 100K in 13 months after October 2022 launch; best for tracking pre-seed AI deal flow
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16. The Batch (DeepLearning.AI)

- **Publisher:** Andrew Ng / DeepLearning.AI
- **Website:** deeplearning.ai/the-batch
- **Frequency:** Weekly (Wednesdays)
- **Audience:** AI learners, practitioners, executives — anyone wanting a trusted curated overview

- **Content:** Andrew Ng's personal editorial letter on trends + curated weekly AI news and research roundup
 - **Subscribers:** Hundreds of thousands (DeepLearning.AI has 7M+ course learners)
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Andrew Ng's personal weekly letter is a unique editorial asset; trusted institutional voice
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17. AI Supremacy

- **Publisher:** Michael Spencer
 - **Website:** ai-supremacy.com
 - **Frequency:** 3-6x/week
 - **Audience:** AI enthusiasts, software engineers, tech workers; business/market analysis focus
 - **Content:** AI market trends, Big Tech competitive analysis, future of work predictions, geopolitics of AI
 - **Subscribers:** ~250,000
 - **Cost:** Paid (~\$6/month or ~\$65/year)
 - **Notable:** One of the most successful paid AI newsletters; provides market-oriented analysis at a low price point
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18. Turing Post

- **Publisher:** Ksenia Se (founder)
 - **Website:** turingpost.com
 - **Frequency:** Weekly
 - **Audience:** Builders, researchers, executives, AI governance professionals; readers include Hugging Face founders and NVIDIA executives
 - **Content:** AI systems, models, ideas; LLMs, agents, AI geopolitics (Foreign AI Affairs), unicorn company profiles (OpenAI, Anthropic, Hugging Face, Cohere)
 - **Subscribers:** 110,000+
 - **Cost:** Freemium (free + paid Substack)
 - **Notable:** Curates 150+ newsletters so readers don't have to; "Foreign AI Affairs" covers AI in China, Russia, Israel, Europe
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19. Eye on AI

- **Publisher:** Craig S. Smith (longtime New York Times correspondent)
 - **Website:** eye-on.ai
 - **Frequency:** Weekly (newsletter + biweekly podcast)
 - **Audience:** Industry professionals, the financing/investment community, executives
 - **Content:** Original articles on AI business, strategy, and impact; aggregated news and event coverage
 - **Cost:** Free
 - **Notable:** Craig Smith's deep journalism background brings editorial rigor; explicitly targets the financing and investment community
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20. Stratechery

- **Publisher:** Ben Thompson (former Apple and Microsoft strategist)
- **Website:** stratechery.com
- **Frequency:** 3x/week (mix of free and paid)
- **Audience:** Tech executives, investors, strategists, founders who think deeply about platform dynamics
- **Content:** Business strategy and competitive analysis of the tech industry including AI; long-form analysis, not news roundups

- **Subscribers:** 40,000+ paid
- **Cost:** Freemium (\$120/year for full access)
- **Notable:** The original paid-newsletter model that many others emulated; generates ~\$3M/year as a single-person operation; Ben Thompson's frameworks have influenced an entire generation of tech leaders

CATEGORY 5: AI POLICY, ETHICS & SAFETY

21. AI as Normal Technology (formerly AI Snake Oil)

- **Publisher:** Arvind Narayanan (Princeton CS professor, director of CITEP) & Sayash Kapoor (Princeton PhD)
- **Website:** normaltech.ai
- **Frequency:** Regular (Substack)
- **Audience:** Researchers, policy makers, journalists, AI enthusiasts wanting critical perspectives
- **Content:** Critical analysis of AI capabilities and hype; policy implications; skeptical intellectual alternative to superintelligence narratives
- **Subscribers:** 60,000–70,000
- **Cost:** Free
- **Notable:** Authors on TIME 100 AI list; companion to their Princeton University Press book "AI Snake Oil"

22. AI Safety Newsletter (CAIS)

- **Publisher:** Center for AI Safety (CAIS)
- **Website:** safe.ai/newsletter
- **Frequency:** Regular
- **Audience:** AI safety researchers, policy professionals, general public interested in AI risks
- **Content:** Developments in AI and AI safety — technical and non-technical; no background required; has companion podcast
- **Cost:** Free
- **Notable:** Backed by CAIS, the organization behind the landmark 2023 statement on AI extinction risk signed by leading AI researchers

23. CSET Newsletter (Georgetown)

- **Publisher:** Georgetown University's Center for Security and Emerging Technology
- **Website:** cset.georgetown.edu/newsletters
- **Frequency:** Monthly / periodic
- **Audience:** Policy makers, national security professionals, government officials, researchers
- **Content:** AI talent, data, compute as foundations of AI power; AI in cybersecurity and national security; AI geopolitics (chip exports, China, DOD)
- **Cost:** Free
- **Notable:** Flagship recurring feature: "Mapping the AI Governance Landscape" (updated April 2026)

24. AI Policy Weekly / Luiza's Newsletter

- **Publisher:** Various (Alisar Mustafa, Luiza Jarovsky, et al.)
- **Website:** aipolicyus.substack.com; luizasnewsletter.com
- **Frequency:** Weekly
- **Audience:** Policy professionals, legal experts, civil society, EU/US regulatory watchers
- **Content:** Deepfakes, AI elections, AI safety regulation, EU AI Act, US Executive Orders, current AI policy developments

- **Subscribers:** Luiza's Newsletter: 95,000+
- **Cost:** Free / Freemium

CATEGORY 6: SPECIALIZED DOMAINS

25. RAISE Health Newsletter (Stanford Medicine)

- **Publisher:** Stanford Medicine + Stanford Institute for Human-Centered AI (HAI)
- **Website:** med.stanford.edu/raisehealth/news/newsletter.html
- **Frequency:** Periodic
- **Audience:** Clinicians, biomedical researchers, healthcare administrators, health AI professionals
- **Content:** AI in biomedical research, education, and patient care; ethical and responsible AI use in healthcare
- **Cost:** Free
- **Notable:** Carries institutional weight of Stanford Medicine + Stanford HAI partnership

26. AI in Healthcare (AIIN.Healthcare)

- **Publisher:** AIIN Healthcare
- **Website:** aiin.healthcare
- **Frequency:** Regular
- **Audience:** C-level health system leaders, hospital executives, physician and IT leaders
- **Content:** Healthcare AI deployments, clinical AI tools, ROI in healthcare AI, governance of health AI
- **Cost:** Free
- **Notable:** Transitioning in 2026 to merged publication "HE" with Health Exec

27. Making AI Work (MIT Technology Review)

- **Publisher:** MIT Technology Review
- **Website:** technologyreview.com
- **Frequency:** Weekly (7-issue series launched February 2026)
- **Audience:** Business professionals and executives implementing AI across organizations
- **Content:** Practical, industry-specific guidance on deploying generative AI; case studies, cross-sector context, action-oriented implementation tips
- **Cost:** Free
- **Notable:** Launched February 2026; MIT Technology Review brand carries significant credibility; structured as a practical implementation guide

QUICK-REFERENCE SUMMARY TABLE

#	Newsletter	Subscribers	Frequency	Cost	Best For
1	The Rundown AI	2M+	Daily	Free	General AI news + tutorials
2	TLDR AI	1.25M+	Daily	Free	Technical engineers
3	Superhuman AI	1M+	Daily	Freemium	Productivity/career
4	The Neuron	550K+	Daily	Free	Beginners, casual readers
5	The Atlas (GenAI.Works)	3.15M+ (LinkedIn)	Biweekly	Free	Cross-industry executives

#	Newsletter	Subscribers	Frequency	Cost	Best For
6	AI Frontier	847K+	Weekly	Free	LinkedIn AI community
7	Learn AI Together	544K+	Regular	Free	AI learners
8	Ahead of AI	190K+	~2x/month	Freemium	LLM architecture/ research
9	Latent Space	200K+	Daily+Weekly	Freemium	AI engineers/builders
10	Import AI	116K+	Weekly	Freemium	Research + policy
11	Interconnects	60K+	1-3x/week	Freemium	Post-training/open models
12	AlphaSignal	100-150K	Weekly	Free	ML practitioners
13	The Gradient	Tens of thousands	Irregular	Free	Researchers/ academics
14	Gradient Updates (Epoch AI)	Tens of thousands	Weekly	Free	AI trajectories/ forecasting
15	Ben's Bites	~163K	Daily	Freemium	Founders/investors
16	The Batch (DeepLearning.AI)	Hundreds of thousands	Weekly	Free	Learners + practitioners
17	AI Supremacy	~250K	3-6x/week	Paid (\$6/mo)	Market/Big Tech analysis
18	Turing Post	110K+	Weekly	Freemium	Researchers + governance
19	Eye on AI	N/A	Weekly	Free	Finance/investment community
20	Stratechery	40K+ paid	3x/week	Freemium (\$120/yr)	Strategy/executives
21	AI as Normal Technology	60-70K	Regular	Free	Critical/policy perspective
22	CAIS AI Safety Newsletter	Tens of thousands	Regular	Free	AI safety professionals
23	CSET Newsletter	N/A	Monthly	Free	National security/ policy
24	AI Policy Weekly / Luiza's	95K+	Weekly	Free/ Freemium	AI regulation/law
25	RAISE Health (Stanford)	N/A	Periodic	Free	Biomedical/ healthcare AI
26	AIIN Healthcare	N/A	Regular	Free	Healthcare executives
27	Making AI Work (MIT TR)	N/A	Weekly (7-issue series)	Free	AI implementation

KEY OBSERVATIONS

1. **Scale polarization:** The market has bifurcated between mega-newsletters (The Atlas at 3M+, The Rundown at 2M+) and high-quality niche publications (Interconnects at 60K, Gradient at tens of thousands). Niche newsletters often have higher engagement and more influential readership.

2. **LinkedIn as a major channel:** Three newsletters in the top 10 by subscriber count (The Atlas, AI Frontier, Learn AI Together) exist primarily on LinkedIn, reflecting the platform's growing role as a B2B content distribution channel.
3. **Freemium is the dominant model:** Nearly every newsletter uses a free-core / paid-extras model. Main exceptions are Stratechery (primarily paid) and AI Supremacy (primarily paid), which use paywalls as quality signals.
4. **Convergence with podcasts:** Latent Space, The Neuron, Eye on AI, and the CAIS Newsletter have all launched companion podcasts — newsletters are becoming multi-format media brands.
5. **Policy and safety are growing:** Several newsletters gained major milestones in 2025–2026 specifically covering AI governance, safety, and regulation, reflecting maturation of the policy debate post-EU AI Act.
6. **Institutional entrants:** MIT Technology Review launched a new AI-specific newsletter ("Making AI Work") in February 2026, signaling major legacy media institutions competing in the AI newsletter space.

Research compiled from: DataNorth AI, Readless, GenAI.Works, Dupple, ClickIT Tech, Refind, The CTO Club, Arize, Substack, PR Newswire, They Got Acquired, LinkedIn, Paved, and primary newsletter sources.